

# — MDT —

THE DOPAMINE AUDIT · YOUR FIRST FIX

## Protect What Matters

*The phone takes whatever you let it. So fence off what you will not.*

### WHY THIS IS THE FIGHT

The real cost of the phone is not the time on the screen, it is what that time quietly replaces, your sleep, your focus, and your attention on the people actually in the room. And a lot of the reaching is escape: when a feeling shows up that you would rather not sit in, the phone is the nearest exit. That is why it is always worst on the hard days.

### HOW IT WORKS

You do not have to quit to win this one. You decide on a small number of things the phone is not allowed to touch, and you defend them like they matter, because they do. And you get honest about the moments you reach for it to avoid something, because naming the feeling takes most of its power away.

### THE FIXES

Charge the phone outside the bedroom, protect your sleep first, it is the keystone that holds the rest up. Make meals phone-free, and make time with the people you love phone-free. Keep a no-phone first hour and last hour to bookend the day. And when you notice your hand reaching to escape a feeling, stop and name the feeling before you pick it up.

### SEVEN DAYS

Print this. Run the fix for a week. Circle Y or N each day, one column per day. One honest week tells you more than a month of good intentions.

|                                                   | 1   | 2   | 3   | 4   | 5   | 6   | 7   |
|---------------------------------------------------|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| Phone charged outside the bedroom                 | Y/N | Y/N | Y/N | Y/N | Y/N | Y/N | Y/N |
| At least one phone-free meal or real conversation | Y/N | Y/N | Y/N | Y/N | Y/N | Y/N | Y/N |

### THE EVENING CHECK

*Each night: what did the phone cost you today, and what did you reach for it to avoid?*

*The feed will take whatever you give it. Decide what you won't.*

This is the fix for the pattern your audit flagged as the tightest grip. Run it for a week before you add another. The other three are waiting when you are ready.